25/7/25

Midnight Visitor

-Robert Arthur

I Answer the following word meanings:-

a Wharily: involves or sounds like wheezing
Sentence The moon glowed wharily through the trees.

b Prosac:
Sentence

c Disillusional: Disappointed by reality
Sentence She felt disillusional after the betrayal.

d Espionage: Practice of spying to obtain secret information
Sentence He was arrested for corporate espionage.

e Countenance: A person's facial expression
Sentence Her calm countenance reassured everyone.

f Grimly: In a serious, gloomy or determined way
Sentence He grimly accepted the bad news

II Reference to Context:-

1 "Ausable did ---------- 20 years ago."
a Who is Ausable and who is he talking to?
Ans Ausable is a secret agent. He is talking to Fowler, a writer who wants to meet a real spy.

b How is Ausable different from others of his class?
Ans Unlike typical secret agents, Ausable is fat, speaks with an American accent, and leads a seemingly dull life.

c Which word from the extract means the same as "The tone of speaking a particular language"?
Ans Accent

III Answer the following Short Answers:-

Q1 Why did Fowler want to meet Ausable? Why was he disappointed?
Ans Fowler, a writer, wanted to meet Ausable because he expected to encounter an exciting, adventurous spy. However, He was disappointed because Ausable seemed ordinary, overweight, and did not fit his heroic expectations. Fowler felt let down by the lack of drama and thrill he had imagined.

Q2 What story Ausable frame about calling the police?
Ans Ausable told Max that the knocking was the police, whom he had called for extra protection. He claimed he asked them to check on him periodically to ensure everything was safe because the important missile report required additional security. This was completely fabricated - there was no police; it was actually Henry the waiter bringing wine Ausable had ordered.

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Q3 'Telling a lie is a sin & Killing someone is a crime'. Why then did Ausable tell lies more than once to kill a man?

Ans Ausable's lies were justified as self-defence, not murder. When Max threatened his life with a gun, Ausable used deception to protect himself and Fowler from immediate danger. His profession as a secret agent involved protecting national security interests. Max's death resulted from his own panicked decision to jump, not from Ausable's intent to kill. The lies served as non-violent resistance against an armed criminal threat.

IV Answer the following Long Answers:-

Q1 Presence of mind and intelligence are more powerful weapons than a gun. How far is it true in case of Ausable, the secret agent.

Ans Ausable's case perfectly demonstrates that presence of mind and intelligence are indeed more powerful weapons than a gun. Despite facing Max, an armed rival agent, Ausable remains calm and uses his wit to fabricate convincing stories about a non-existent balcony and police arrival.

While Max relies on his for intimidation, Ausable cleverly manipulates the situation through psychological warfare. His quick thinking transforms the dangerous encounter into an opportunity, creating false narratives that exploit Max's fears and desperation.

The outcome proves intelligence's superiority over brute force. Max's overconfidence in his weapon becomes his downfall as he panics and jumps to his death, while Ausable achieves victory without violence. This demonstrates that mental agility can overcome physical threats through strategic deception.